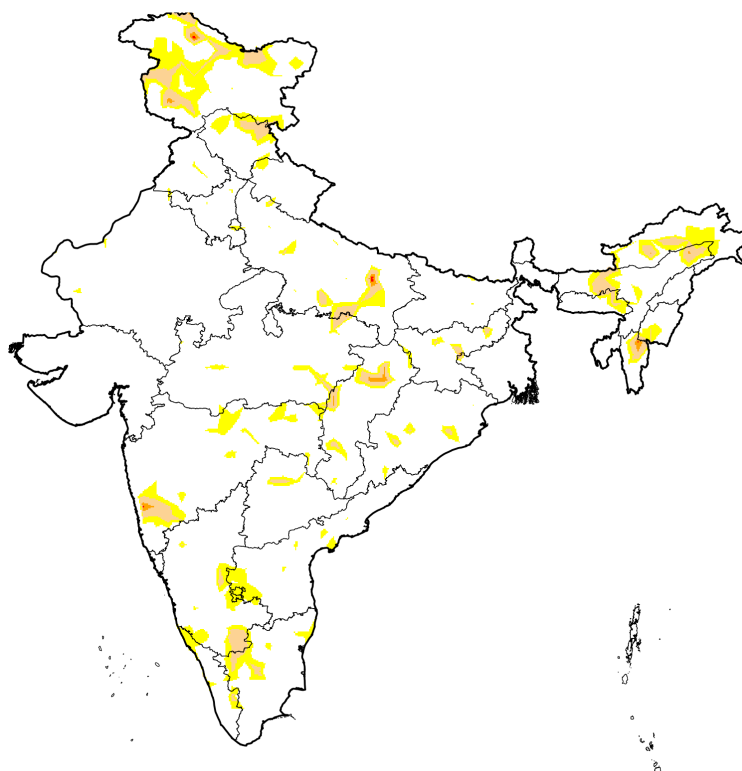




Combined Drought Index (CDI) for the week ending May 20, 2026.

Summary

As of the week ending May 20, 2026, 84.7% of India's area remains in normal conditions, while 15.3% of the country is classified under drought conditions ranging from D0 to D4. The national drought footprint has contracted slightly this week, decreasing by 0.9 percentage points to 15.3% from 16.2% last week, following a peak of 17.2% one month ago. This reduction indicates a gradual easing of drought pressures across the nation.

The impact of drought is highly concentrated in specific regions, with the NCT of Delhi experiencing the most severe situation at 52.2% of its area under drought conditions. Other significantly affected states include Manipur at 42.3%, Mizoram at 40.8%, Arunachal Pradesh at 40.3%, Jammu & Kashmir at 38.9%, and Meghalaya at 34.1%. In contrast, certain states show notably better conditions, with West Bengal reporting 0.0% drought coverage, followed closely by Rajasthan at 1.0%, Gujarat at 2.1%, and Telangana at 3.4%. The cumulative nature of the severity classes means that the 3.1% area classified as D1 or worse already encompasses the more extreme D2, D3, and D4 categories, which together affect a negligible 0.2% of the total national area.

Regional Outlook

North shows moderate, scattered drought: about 28% of the region is in drought (D0–D4).

Northwest shows largely normal conditions: about 4% of the region is in drought (D0–D4).

Northeast shows moderate, scattered drought: about 27% of the region is in drought (D0–D4), with pockets of severe-or-worse conditions.

East shows mostly normal conditions with localised dryness: about 7% of the region is in drought (D0–D4).

Central shows mostly normal conditions with localised dryness: about 15% of the region is in drought (D0–D4), with pockets of severe-or-worse conditions.

West shows moderate, scattered drought: about 22% of the region is in drought (D0–D4).

South shows mostly normal conditions with localised dryness: about 16% of the region is in drought (D0–D4).

Developed by the Water and Climate Lab, IIT Gandhinagar, using hydro-meteorological data from IMD and partner agencies.



2026 Water and Climate Lab · Indian Institute of Technology Gandhinagar · For research and demonstration purposes.